

Ezequiel Molina

Improving service delivery: from diagnosis to evidence-based solutions

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Fifteen years of technical and financial support to governments improving public service delivery, mostly in education: diagnosis (**Teach**, classroom observation in 40+ countries applied to 180,000+ teachers, and the Service Delivery Indicators and SABER surveys), evidence-based solutions that improved outcomes at scale (**Coach** and structured pedagogy, 15+ countries), the financing behind them (results-based contracts, block-grant formulas), and, since 2023, a portfolio of AI products running in Latin American public schools, from math tutors to an offline career coach, that I design, prototype, and evaluate, then scale with ministries, universities, and partner organizations. Winner of the World Bank's inaugural Presidential Innovation Award (2025). 185,000+ downloads of my AI publication series, and a weekly newsletter of practical AI tips read by 10,000+ World Bank staff.

■ AI SOLUTIONS (BUILT HANDS-ON, SELECTED)

- **evalkit**: agentic evaluation harness for learning platforms, AI-based or not. Multi-judge council reviews every test before it exists; rubric-based scoring in which every score must cite hashed evidence artifacts (re-verifiable a year later); high-stakes tests (crisis signals, minors' data) gated behind per-test human signatures. Run end-to-end against a live AI math tutor used in Peruvian public schools: hallucination, cross-session state, and crisis-response behavior. Code: github.com/ezequielmolina-lang/evalkit-wip.
- **Teach + IA**: automated scoring of classroom observations with LLMs on the Teach framework I created: 92.9% agreement with certified human observers across 199 primary classrooms in Peru. Research paper under journal review.
- **El Director LIBRE ("The Liberated Principal") / La IA en el Aula ("AI as a Pedagogical Ally")**: AI training methods for school leaders and teachers, built with Peru's Ministry of Education. 2,000+ school directors trained nationally; 27,000+ downloads since Nov 2025; RCT with 1,270 teachers showing sustained AI adoption 9 months post-training; now embedded in El Salvador's \$500M education transformation with a disbursement-linked indicator, and adapted for Brazil.
- **Eligiendo mi Camino ("Choosing My Path")**: AI career coach for secondary students: 6,000 students across 110 Lima public schools, an eight-step guidance journey drawing on salary data for 130+ occupations, multilingual public chat (zero-PII by design), and an AI reporting assistant for school directors. Pre-registered RCT with the Bank's Development Research Group, among the first rigorous evaluations of an LLM career coach in a low- or middle-income country: career readiness +0.12 SD; technical-enrollment intentions +14%. Cloned for Ecuador. Prototype: ezequielmolina-lang.github.io/eligiendo-mi-camino. Blog: *From Learning to Earning*.
- **Gallito (offline small language model)**: distilled a small language model from thousands of anonymized Claude coaching conversations so the career coach runs fully offline, as a native Windows app or in-browser on locked school Chromebooks, with nothing leaving the device. Evaluated against the cloud model in my own harness, results published in full: 1.55/2 vs 1.85/2 on coaching quality, hallucination rates of 7.5% vs 1.2%. Live: eligiendomicamino.org/offline.
- **APD (Autonomous Project Design)**: generator of World Bank project designs that starts from each country's diagnostics and the sitting government's own priorities, so proposals are technically grounded and politically viable. Scored by a blind multi-LLM judge panel with per-judge rubrics, calibrated against the Bank's official project-outcome ratings, and shipped as a live design-critique tool grounded in 350+ real project documents.
- **AI Tuesday**: a weekly AI newsletter no one asked for. I write and ship it myself; with no mandate and no promotion it reached 10,000+ World Bank staff across all regions over 50+ editions, because readers found it useful. Now the Bank's de facto channel for moving non-technical staff to working AI use.
- **Adoption telemetry and playbooks**: self-built activation instrumentation for every program: an event pipeline that logs each training-module interaction across cohort tracks, platform-log dormancy analysis that redesigned a national tutoring offer around actual usage instead of surveys, and per-cycle rollout playbooks that reduce launching a new cohort to a one-line registry change.

■ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

THE WORLD BANK Washington, DC · Lima · 2006 to present

Senior Economist, Lead for EdTech and Teachers, Latin America (2023 to present)

- **One-to-many adoption motion, region-wide**: run the scaled funnel for AI programs across Latin America and the Caribbean: standardized products localized per country, ministry onboarding, training cohorts, embedded evaluation, and graduation into financed operations.

- **Lending and advisory operations:** co-lead of Peru’s \$82.5M Science, Technology and Innovation project; advisor to El Salvador’s \$500M transformational EdTech and AI education reform; paid advisory to Chile’s Ministry of Education and Budget Office on early-childhood financing. Rebuilt a stalled government relationship after a ministerial transition and converted initial resistance into a flagship national AI initiative, later showcased by Microsoft’s CEO.
- **Ecosystem partnerships:** led the education-digitalization MoU with the Inter-American Development Bank; built a public-private coalition (Microsoft, Anthropic, and 900+ universities) to scale AI teacher training nationally; working partnerships with Google and Fundación Romero. Convene **EvidenciA**, the Latin American network on AI and learning science: seven partner organizations, a shared evidence base, and syntheses showing that design, not the model, determines learning outcomes.
- **Field-to-product loop:** Presidential Innovation Award pilots now running: an AI math tutor in 85 Lima schools and the Gallito career coach for secondary students, solutions I designed and prototyped hands-on and develop with uDocz as technology partner, plus AI procurement agents inside the Ministry of Education, each with evaluation designs feeding what gets scaled next.

Senior Economist / Economist, Global Knowledge and Innovation Unit; Global Lead for Teachers (2017 to 2023)

- **Product ownership at global scale:** built **Teach** from concept through validation to adoption in 40+ countries: 180,000+ teachers, 3.6M students, 10+ languages, taken up by UNESCO, UNICEF and NGOs, informing \$2B+ in education lending. Set direction, made the tradeoffs, shipped it, and led a 15-person global team supporting country teams in every World Bank region to improve their education systems.
- **Fundraising as GTM:** conceived **Coach**, the Bank’s global program for in-service teacher professional development (15+ countries), and raised \$7M from Finland and Porticus; \$10M+ total trust funds closed through investment cases and donor pipeline management.
- **Turnaround:** took Lao PDR’s \$47M national education program from 4% to 25% disbursement in one year through intensive client work; designed the results-based contract (5 disbursement-linked indicators) and the block-grant formula funding 4,500+ schools in 148 districts.

Earlier roles (2006 to 2017)

- Core team, World Development Report 2017 (chapter author); led national service-delivery surveys in Afghanistan, Tanzania and Mozambique; Gender Innovation Lab; selected into the Bank’s Young Professionals Program.

■ EDUCATION

- **Ph.D., Political Economy, Princeton University** (2013); dissertation on the political economy of service delivery. MPP, Princeton (2011). M.A. and B.A. Economics, Universidad Nacional de La Plata, Argentina (top-5 GPA award).

■ REACH, EVIDENCE AND RECOGNITION

- **WBG Presidential Innovation Award (2025), inaugural:** 1 of 7 winners Bank-wide, for “From Learning to Earning: Leveraging AI to Develop Skills for Jobs.”
- **Distribution:** AI publication series with 185,000+ downloads in two years: AI Revolution in Education (79,000+), AI Revolution in Higher Education (41,000+), El Director LIBRE (27,000+), Screen Time in Early Childhood (17,000+).
- **Research:** background paper to World Development Report 2026 (“Can EdTech Close Learning Gaps?”, with A. Burneo, L. Dinarte-Diaz, and C. Lopez); 7 peer-reviewed articles, including Journal of Economic Perspectives and Teaching and Teacher Education.
- Work featured in The Economist, El Mercurio, and Infobae.

■ TECHNICAL AND LANGUAGES

- **Measurement and evaluation:** survey design and large-scale data collection, instrument development and validation, RCT design and impact evaluation, and LLM evaluation (rubrics, judge panels, evidence-cited scoring).
- **Daily Claude builder:** agentic workflows, eval harnesses, serverless Claude apps (vision, RAG, judge panels) designed, shipped, and maintained solo. Python, SQL, R, Stata.
- **Languages:** Spanish (native), English (fluent), Portuguese (professional).